

FOOD FOR LIFE



Elementary school children choose healthy foods at a school cafeteria in Hagerstown, Maryland, U.S.A.

GOALS

IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL:

- Read about how a celebrity chef wants people to eat better.
- Learn about problems with the food served in some schools.
- Explore ways to encourage healthy eating

THINK AND DISCUSS

1. What kinds of foods do you like to eat?
Do you think your diet is healthy?
2. What problems can people have if they eat the wrong foods?

Lesson A

PRE-READING

A. Look at the infographic on page 82 and note your answers to the questions below.

1. Which three countries are mentioned?

United States, England, Australia

2. What do you think the sentence “Kids are so out of touch with what’s on their plates” means?

Kids don't understand about individual foods because the meals they eat are processed.

- B.** Read the introduction to the reading passage on page 80. Write down your answers to the questions below. Then discuss your ideas with a partner.

Predictions will vary. Actual answers are:

1. Why do you think Huntington might be the unhealthiest place in the U.S.A.?

In 2009, Huntington had the highest obesity rate in America.

2. What kind of “revolution” do you think Jamie Oliver is trying to lead?

Oliver’s movement aims to improve people’s eating habits and health.



FOOD REVOLUTION

Sisters eat hamburgers at a fast-food stand in Austin, Texas, U.S.A.



FOOD REVOLUTION

In 2009, Huntington, West Virginia, was called the unhealthiest city in the United States. Jamie Oliver, a chef and activist, wanted to help—and started a food **revolution**.

Celebrity chef Jamie Oliver is on a mission to change people's eating habits. As part of his mission, Oliver opened a new community food center in Huntington, West Virginia, in 2009. Oliver chose Huntington largely because of the city's high rates of food-related illnesses.



At the time, over 45 percent of the adult population was obese, according to a government report. Oliver's team spent five months in Huntington coaching people about fresh food. At the food center, called Jamie's Kitchen, his team taught cooking lessons and served healthy meals. Three years after the Kitchen opened, obesity levels in Huntington had dropped by 10 percent.

NO FOOD CULTURE

In his books and on his TV shows, Oliver highlights why eating healthily is such a challenge today. At the heart of the issue is **widespread** ignorance. Oliver thinks many people, particularly children, are out of touch with what's on their plates. They are not aware of the ingredients in the food they eat or how it was made. At home, at school, and on Main Street, people are no longer learning about good food, cooking, and healthy eating.



In the past, Oliver explains, dinners at home were usually cooked with fresh ingredients. However, over the past 30 years, convenience foods have **replaced** fresh home-cooked meals. These convenience foods are highly processed and full of additives. While these additives increase the shelf life of foods, they can be harmful to our health. Processed foods are also common in schools. Too often, the main criterion for choosing which meals to serve is cost. This means children are fed meals that are mass-produced using unhealthy ingredients.

Oliver also sees problems on “Main Street”—the stores and restaurants where people buy food. Fast-food restaurants offer cheap meals that are often high in sugar and fat, but low in nutrition. Additionally, the portion sizes in many restaurants are huge, encouraging people to eat more than is healthy. In supermarkets, food labeling can be confusing or misleading. For example, Oliver wonders how supermarkets can “say something is low-fat when it’s full of so much sugar.”



CREATING A MOVEMENT

Oliver has some ideas about how we can address these problems. For example, he encourages people to share simple recipes, so that more people get into the habit of home cooking. He also suggests that supermarkets hire “food ambassadors” to help **consumers** make better choices about the foods they buy. He **urges** big food brands to provide better labeling on their products. He has also worked with schools to develop healthier meals, and to help children learn about good **nutrition**.

Inspired by his experiences in Huntington, Oliver created an annual event called Food Revolution Day. Food Revolution Day events raise **awareness** of how food affects our well-being and remind people that cooking with fresh ingredients is fun. In 2014, groups in over 100 countries **participated**. Through initiatives like Food Revolution Day and Jamie’s Kitchen, Jamie Oliver hopes people will live healthier lives. Oliver wants to create “a movement to educate every child about food [and] to inspire families to cook again.”

processed food: *n.* packaged foods that have been prepared in order to make them last longer

Kids are so out of touch with what's on their plates that they don't realize real food doesn't come from a box.

AT SCHOOL



Food education is not compulsory worldwide

96%

of children in the U.K. don't eat the recommended amount of fruits and vegetables

The average American elementary-age child receives only

3.4 hours

of food education per year

AT HOME



less than most children watch TV each day

In Australia



20%

of children believe that pasta comes from animals

27%

think yogurt comes from plants

1910

meals eaten out of home:

2%

2010

meals eaten out of home:

50%



1 in 4 Americans visits a fast-food restaurant daily

ON MAIN STREET

Americans spend more than

\$110 billion



per year on fast food



This is the third generation of children that won't know how to cook

these habits are making people **SICK**



Jamie Oliver teaches a student about healthy cooking as part of his TV show in Los Angeles, U.S.A.

Developing Reading Skills

UNDERSTANDING THE MAIN IDEAS

- A.** Use the information from the passage on pages 80–82. What is the reading mainly about? Choose the best answer(s).
1. How eating habits can be improved
 2. How eating habits have changed in Huntington
 3. Why Jamie's Kitchen was successful
- B.** How does Oliver want to improve people's eating habits? Write your ideas and then share them with a partner.

He wants people to use fresh ingredients and stay away from processed foods.

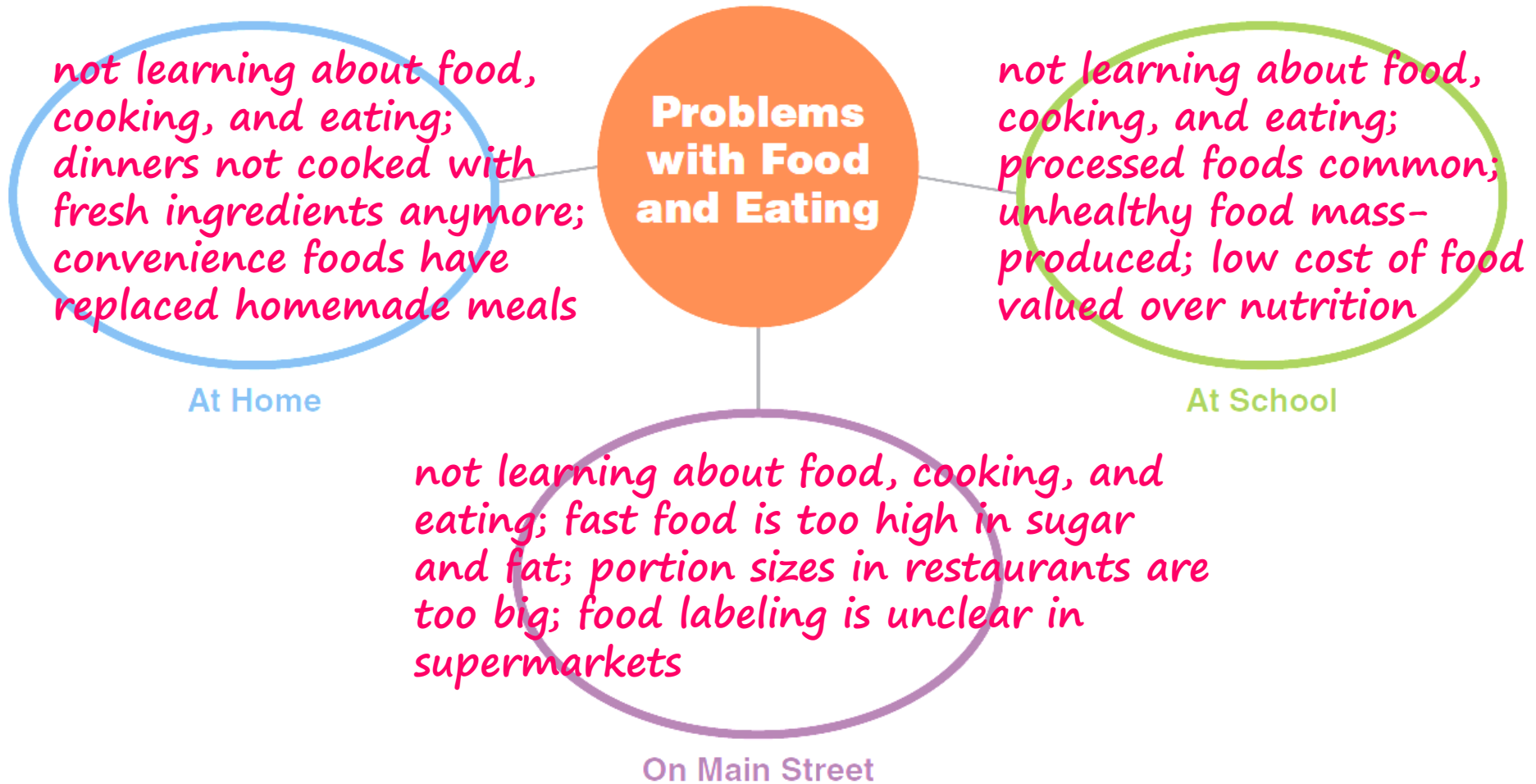
IDENTIFYING PROBLEMS AND SOLUTIONS

Writers sometimes explain problems and solutions in a reading passage. These may be provided within the same paragraph, or in separate paragraphs or sections.

A. Read the passage on pages 80–82 again. Which paragraphs include examples of problems? Which paragraphs include solutions? Check (✓) the boxes.

	Problems	Solutions
Paragraph 2	✓	
Paragraph 3	✓	
Paragraph 4	✓	
Paragraph 5		✓
Paragraph 6		✓

B. Use information from the reading passage on pages 80–82 to complete this concept map.



- C. What are four solutions Oliver proposes to solve some of the problems? Write your ideas and then share them with a partner.**

home cooks share simple recipes with each other;
supermarkets become “food ambassadors”; food brands
provide better labeling; schools serve healthier meals

UNDERSTANDING INFOGRAPHICS

Use the infographic on page 82 to complete each sentence below.

1. Only four percent of children in the U.K. eat the recommended amount of fruits and vegetables.
2. In 2010, 50 percent of all meals were eaten out of (the) home.
3. This is the third generation of children that won't know how to cook.
4. Most children watch more hours of TV in one day than they get hours of food education in a year.
5. These changes at home and school are making people sick.

BUILDING VOCABULARY

A. Circle the correct word to complete each sentence.

1. For a healthier snack, replace / participate ice cream with frozen yogurt.
2. For proper awareness / nutrition, you must eat a healthy, balanced diet.
3. Health experts urge / replace people to eat less fried food.
4. As a consumer / revolution, you have a right to know what's in the food you buy.

B. Match the words (1–6) to the correct definition (a–d). Two words are extra.

- | | |
|-------------------------|---|
| <u>c</u> 1. revolution | a. common among many people |
| <u>a</u> 2. widespread | b. to take part in an activity or event |
| <u>–</u> 3. urge | c. a sudden or significant change in the way we live, work, or are governed |
| <u>d</u> 4. awareness | d. an understanding of something |
| <u>b</u> 5. participate | |
| <u>–</u> 6. nutrition | |

GETTING MEANING FROM CONTEXT

- A.** The passage mentions that people should “get into the habit” of home cooking. What does that phrase mean? Note some ideas and discuss with a partner.

to start to do something regularly in your daily life

- B.** The passage states that, “Over the past 30 years, *convenience foods* have replaced fresh home-cooked meals.” What are some examples of convenience foods?

Answers will vary, but convenience foods are not prepared from fresh ingredients and are usually processed. Possibilities include: any fast food, junk food like potato chips, frozen foods, foods made from processed ingredients like hot dogs, etc.

CRITICAL THINKING

1. **Applying.** How are your eating habits similar to or different from the habits mentioned in the reading passage? *Answers will vary.*
2. **Reflecting.** Oliver wants supermarkets to hire “food ambassadors.” What do you think the role of a food ambassador would be? Do you think it’s a good idea?

Answers will vary. Possibilities include: Encourage customers at the supermarket to use fresh ingredients by holding cooking classes, offering demonstrations, and sharing recipes; ensuring the supermarket sells products with clear labeling.

EXPLORE MORE

Read about Oliver’s Ministry of Food project in England at jamieoliver.com/jamies-ministry-offood. Find out what people can do at each of the different centers. Share your findings with your class.

The centers teach topics such as cooking skills, how to make easy homemade meals, food shopping skills, etc.



TEACH EVERY CHILD ABOUT FOOD

JAMIE OLIVER Chef and activist, TED speaker

Jamie Oliver's passion for cooking started in the kitchen of his parents' restaurant and pub. He has made over a dozen TV series and has published many bestselling cookbooks. As well as a chef, Oliver is an activist who educates people on how to eat more healthily.

In 2004, Oliver began working to improve the quality of food served at U.K. schools. In 2009, he brought a similar campaign to the United States. He recognizes that there are many other people—from health experts to lunch ladies—trying to achieve similar goals. But there are many challenges to overcome, particularly lack of funding. Oliver thinks we need to identify and thank these people and give them the resources they need.



In 2010, he was awarded the TED prize—a donation of one million dollars to make someone's wish come true. Jamie Oliver's wish is to educate people about food, and hopefully improve people's lives. "I'm not a doctor; I'm a chef," he says. "I don't have expensive equipment or medicine. I use information [and] education."

In this lesson, you are going to watch segments of Oliver's TED Talk. Use the information above to answer the questions.

1. How did Oliver get interested in cooking?

His parents owned a restaurant and pub.

2. What main challenge do people face when trying to improve the quality of food in schools?

funding

3. What is Oliver's wish?

to educate people about food and improve their lives

TEDTALKS

Jamie Oliver's **idea worth spreading** is that we need to educate children about food, inspire families to cook, and empower people to fight obesity.

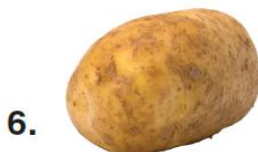


PART 1

GUESS THE VEGETABLE

PREVIEWING

A. In the first segment of Oliver's talk, he asks schoolchildren to name particular vegetables. How well do you know these items? Match the pictures (1–6) to the correct words (a–f).



4 a. mushroom

5 b. eggplant

1 c. tomato

6 d. potato

2 e. cauliflower

3 f. beetroot

B. Read this excerpt from Oliver's talk. Which of the bold words do you think he uses?

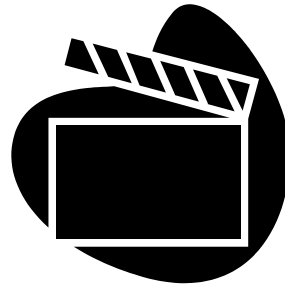
“What’s the (1) **problem** / **purpose** of school? School was always invented to arm us with the tools to make us creative, do wonderful things, make us earn a living, etc. [. . .] But we haven’t really evolved it to deal with the (2) **health** / **hunger** catastrophes of America, OK? School food is something that most (3) **parents** / **kids**—31 million a day, actually—have twice a day, more than often, breakfast and lunch, 180 days of the year. So you could say that school food is quite (4) **easy** / **important**, really . . . ”

evolved: v. changed and developed

catastrophe: n. something that causes a lot of damage; a disaster

GETTING THE MAIN IDEA

- A.** Watch (▶) the first segment of the talk and check your answers to the Previewing questions above.



- B.** What is this segment of the talk mainly about? Complete the sentences with your own ideas.

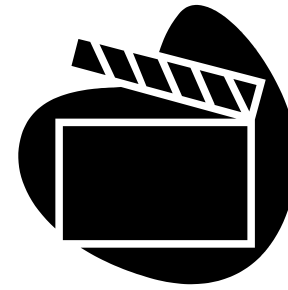
1. The problem with children not knowing the names of the vegetables is that if they don't know what it is, they won't eat it.
2. The solution Jamie Oliver suggests is educating kids about food in schools

STOP THE SUGAR

PREVIEWING

Look at the photo of Jamie Oliver. Why do you think he is pushing a wheelbarrow onto the stage?

Predictions will vary. He is showing the audience how much sugar schoolchildren consume from drinking flavored milk two times a day.



GETTING THE MAIN IDEA

In many schools in the United States, milk must be offered to children with every meal. Answer the questions with your ideas. Then check your answers as you watch (▶) the next segment of Oliver's talk.

1. What ingredients are added to the milk served in schools?

flavorings, colorings, and sugar

2. Why are these ingredients added?

so kids will drink it

3. How much sugar does flavored milk contain compared to a fizzy drink (soda)?

the same amount

4. Does Oliver think giving milk to schoolchildren is a bad idea?

He thinks giving flavored milk to children is a bad idea.

Jamie Oliver on the TED stage



CRITICAL THINKING

1. **Inferring.** Jamie Oliver talks about children not using cutlery. Why do you think it's a problem that kids do not use knives and forks to eat?

Children who get used to eating without cutlery will think eating fast food is normal.

2. **Evaluating.** Do you think the wheelbarrow of sugar helped Oliver make his point? What do you think it added to his presentation?

Answers will vary.

PART 3

A NEW STANDARD

UNDERSTANDING KEY DETAILS

- A.** Read the excerpt from the next segment of Oliver's talk. What key points is he making? Choose the two best statements.

"In schools, we owe it to [children] to make sure those 180 days of the year . . . [they] need to be cooked proper, fresh food from local growers on-site. There needs to be a new standard of fresh, proper food for your children.

It's profoundly important that every single American child leaves school knowing how to cook ten recipes that will save their life. That means that they can be students, young parents, and be able to sort of duck and dive around the basics of cooking, no matter what recession hits them next time."

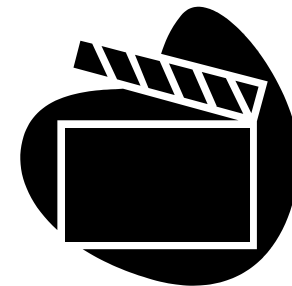
duck and dive: *idiom* to be clever enough to understand and deal with a situation

recession: *n.* a period of time when the economy of a country is doing badly

- ① Schools should provide a better standard of fresh food for students.
2. Students should spend more time growing their own ingredients in school.
3. Children should all leave school knowing the same ten recipes.
- ④ Oliver thinks that if you can cook, you will do better during bad economic times.

B. Now watch (▶) the rest of Oliver's talk. How would you describe his emotions during this segment of the talk? Compare your answers with a partner.

Answers will vary. Oliver seems to feel very strongly about what he is saying.



CRITICAL THINKING

Reflecting. Oliver says that every child should know how to cook “ten recipes that will save their life.” List ten meals you think are important to know how to make. What makes these ten healthy and life-saving?

Answers will vary.

EXPLORE MORE

Watch Oliver’s full TED Talk at TED.com. How do the residents of Huntington feel about Jamie’s Kitchen? Share your opinions with your class.

Project



Jamie Oliver broadcasts a live cooking class to schoolchildren across the globe as part of the third annual Food Revolution Day in 2014 in London, U.K.

Project

A. Work with a partner. You're going to plan an event for Food Revolution Day. Choose from the following or use your own idea.

- Enroll your class in a Ministry of Food cooking class.
- Organize a trip to your local farmer's market.
- Campaign to get cooking skills on the curriculum at a school.

B. Go to the Food Revolution Day website and research your idea.

C. Design a flyer to promote the event. Include the following information.

- What is the event?
- When is it taking place?
- Who can participate?
- Why is it important to take part?

Project

D. Post your flyer on the classroom wall, along with your classmates' flyers. With your class, discuss the following:

1. Which flyer is the best? Why?
2. What Food Revolution Day activities sound the most interesting?
3. Are you likely to join the event? Why or why not?

EXPLORE MORE

Find out about the most recent Food Revolution Day. Which events do you think were the most interesting and successful? Why? Share what you learn with your class.

Part 1

. . . OK, school. What is school? Who invented it? What's the purpose of school? School was always invented to arm us with the tools to make us creative, do wonderful things, make us earn a living, etc., etc., etc. You know, it's been kind of in this sort of tight box for a long, long time. OK? But we haven't really evolved it to deal with the health catastrophes of America, OK? School food is something that most kids—31 million a day, actually—have twice a day, more than often, breakfast and lunch, 180 days of the year. So you could say that school food is quite important, really, judging the circumstances. . . .

Now, the reality is, the food that your kids get every day is fast food, it's highly processed, there's not enough fresh food in there at all. You know, the amount of additives, E numbers, ingredients you wouldn't believe—there's not enough veggies at all. French fries are considered a vegetable. Pizza for breakfast. They don't even get given crockery. Knives and forks? No, they're too dangerous. They have scissors in the classroom, but knives and forks? No. And the way I look at it is: If you don't have knives and forks in your school, you're purely endorsing, from a state level, fast food, because it's handheld. And yes, by the way, it is fast food: It's sloppy joes, it's burgers, it's wieners, it's pizzas, it's all of that stuff. Ten percent of what we spend on healthcare, as I said earlier, is on obesity, and it's going to double. We're not teaching our kids. There's no statutory right to teach kids about food, elementary or secondary school. OK? We don't teach kids about food. Right? And this is a little clip from an elementary school, which is very common in England.

[Video] Jamie Oliver: Who knows what this is?

Child: Potatoes.

JO: Potato? So, you think these are potatoes? Do you know what that is? Do you know what that is?

Child: Broccoli?

JO: What about this? Our good old friend. Do you know what this is, honey?

Child: Celery.

JO: No. What do you think this is?

Child: Onion.

JO: Onion? No.

JO: Immediately you get a really clear sense of: Do the kids know anything about where food comes from?

JO: Who knows what that is?

Child: Uh, pear?

JO: What do you think this is?

Child: I don't know.

JO: If the kids don't know what stuff is, then they will never eat it.

Normal. England and America, England and America. Guess what fixed that.
Guess what fixed that: Two one-hour sessions. We've got to start teaching our kids about food in schools, period.

Part 2

I want to tell you about something that kind of epitomizes the trouble that we're in, guys. OK? I want to talk about something so basic as milk. Every kid has the right to milk at school. Your kids will be having milk at school, breakfast and lunch. Right? They'll be having two bottles. OK? And most kids do. But milk ain't good enough anymore. Because someone at the milk board, right—and don't get me wrong, I support milk—but someone at the milk board probably paid a lot of money for some geezer to work out that if you put loads of flavorings and colorings and sugar in milk, right, more kids will drink it. Yeah. . . .

For me, there ain't no need to flavor the milk. Okay? There's sugar in everything. I know the ins and outs of those ingredients. It's in everything. Even the milk hasn't escaped the kind of modern-day problems. There's our milk. There's our carton. In that is nearly as much sugar as one of your favorite cans of fizzy pop, and they are having two a day. So, let me just show you. We've got one kid, here, having, you know, eight tablespoons of sugar a day. You know, there's your week. There's your month. And I've taken the liberty of putting in just the five years of elementary school sugar, just from milk. . . .

Part 3

Obviously in schools we owe it to them to make sure those 180 days of the year, from that little precious age of four, til 18, 20, 24, whatever, they need to be cooked proper, fresh food from local growers on site. OK? There needs to be a new standard of fresh, proper food for your children. Yeah?

Under the circumstances, it's profoundly important that every single American child leaves school knowing how to cook 10 recipes that will save their life. Life skills.

That means that they can be students, young parents, and be able to sort of duck and dive around the basics of cooking, no matter what recession hits them next time. If you can cook, recession money doesn't matter. If you can cook, time doesn't matter. . . .

I know it's weird having an English person standing here before you talking about all this. All I can say is: I care. I'm a father, and I love this country, and I believe truly, actually, that if change can be made in this country, beautiful things will happen around the world. If America does it, I believe other people will follow. It's incredibly important.

When I was in Huntington, trying to get a few things to work when they weren't, I thought "If I had a magic wand, what would I do?" And I thought, "You know what? I'd just love to be put in front of some of the most amazing movers and shakers in America." And a month later, TED phoned me up and gave me this award. I'm here. So, my wish. Dyslexic, so I'm a bit slow. My wish is for you to help a strong, sustainable movement to educate every child about food, to inspire families to cook again, and to empower people everywhere to fight obesity.

Thank you.